Social Media Policy

Policy Summary & Knowledge Check

Authority	Board of Directors
Date Ratified	December 10, 2025
Next Review Date	December 2028
Previous Amendments	January 16, 2023; November 29, 2019; July 10, 2012; May 23, 2012

Policy Summary

This policy provides guidelines for staff and volunteer conduct in relation to social media communications, augmenting employees' responsibilities under the Acceptable Use Policy. It applies to USC employees and most volunteers (excluding certain elected or independent roles) and sets out core principles — transparency, accuracy, non-discrimination, professionalism, branding, confidentiality, and use of generative AI — along with rules on separating personal and work accounts, account ownership, and consequences for violations.

Key Takeaways

- Applies to all USC employees (including Executives, interns, part-time and full-time staff, and other salaried student positions) and volunteers (associates, coordinators, and committee members); it does not apply to elected Council members, student Senators, Board of Governors representatives, the Gazette, or CHRW.
- The policy specifically contemplates Facebook, Instagram, TikTok, and X, though its principles extend to other platforms; employees and volunteers must also follow the Acceptable Use Policy when using social media.
- Transparency requires staff and volunteers to identify their USC relationship when posting about USC-related responsibilities and prohibits posting anonymously on USC-related topics.
- Non-Discrimination prohibits transmitting messages with derogatory remarks about a person's race, colour, sex, age, disability, religion, national origin, physical attributes, or sexual preference.
- Confidentiality prohibits transmitting sensitive, confidential, restricted, non-public, or proprietary information — including trade secrets — over social media.
- Under the Use of Generative AI principle, AI-generated graphics, photos, or videos should not be used for official USC social media channels, and any AI-generated text must be verified and never published without human oversight.
- Official USC social media activity should use a dedicated account separate from personal accounts (Executive members are exempt from this specific clause, but not from the rest of the policy); staff and volunteers should not use personal accounts to comment on USC-related topics.
- USC social media accounts are USC property; employees and volunteers have no ownership rights over content, followers, or other materials, and new USC-related accounts require consultation with the Communications Department and ITS team.
- Failure to comply with this policy may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination.

Knowledge Check

5 situational questions to check understanding of this policy. An answer key follows on the next page.

Q1. An employee wants to use AI-generated video content directly on an official USC social media account. Is this permitted?

A. Yes, if approved by any coworker.
B. Yes, without any restriction.
C. Yes, as long as it looks professional.

D. No — AI-generated graphics, photos, or videos should not be used for official USC social media channels.

Q2. A volunteer posts a comment about a USC policy on their personal social media account without identifying their USC relationship. What principle does this violate?

A. Transparency, which requires identifying a USC relationship and prohibits anonymous posting on USC topics.

B. Confidentiality.

C. Non-Discrimination.

D. Branding.

Q3. Which platforms are specifically named as being contemplated by this policy, while its general principles still extend elsewhere?

A. LinkedIn, Snapchat, Pinterest, and Reddit.

B. Facebook, Instagram, TikTok, and X.

C. YouTube and Twitch only.

D. WhatsApp and Telegram.

Q4. Who owns the content, followers, and materials associated with an official USC social media account?

A. Ownership transfers to the employee upon departure.

B. The employee or volunteer who created the account.

C. The USC — employees and volunteers have no ownership rights over these.

D. Jointly owned by the USC and the account's creator.

Q5. A staff member wants to create a new official USC-related social media account. What must happen first?

A. Only the President can create new accounts personally.

B. It requires a resolution of the Board of Directors.

C. They can create it immediately without approval.

D. It must be created in consultation with the USC's Communications Department and ITS team.

Answer Key

Q1: D — Section 3.7 states AI-generated graphics, photos, or videos should not be used for official USC social media channels.

Q2: A — Section 3.1 (Transparency) requires staff and volunteers to identify their relationship to the USC and states it is unacceptable to assume an anonymous identity on USC-related topics.

Q3: B — Section 2.3 states the policy specifically contemplates Facebook, Instagram, TikTok, and X, while its general principles extend to other platforms.

Q4: C — Section 5.1 states USC social media accounts are property of the USC, and employees and volunteers have no ownership rights over content, followers, or other materials.

Q5: D — Section 5.3 states new USC-related social media accounts can only be created in consultation with the Communications Department and ITS team.